

Academic vocabulary: Exercises

A) Exercise: Replacing Phrasal Verbs with Formal Verbs

TASK: Rewrite each sentence by replacing the **phrasal verb** (in bold) with a more formal, academic verb. Choose the correct formal verb from the list provided.

Formal Verb List:

identify
review
accelerate
postpone

reduce
develop
determine
formulate

establish
enhance

-
1. Researchers are working to **find out** how catalysts can speed up chemical reactions at a lower energy cost. *identify*
 2. The team tried to **bring down** the environmental impact of the new chemical process by using sustainable materials. *develop*
 3. The scientists need to **look over** the data from the molecular simulations before publishing their findings. *review*
 4. Machine learning algorithms are being used to **come up with** novel drug compounds for pharmaceutical research.
 5. AI models can be trained to **find out** anomalies in large datasets more efficiently than traditional methods.
 6. The research group is aiming to **set up** a model that can predict chemical reaction outcomes with greater accuracy. *establish*
 7. In AI-driven chemistry, scientists are using deep learning techniques to **improve** the precision of reaction mechanisms. *enhance*
 8. The team needs to **come up with** a strategy to reduce the bias in the AI algorithm used for material discovery.
 9. To meet the project deadline, they decided to **put off** the experiment and focus on data analysis instead. *postpone*
 10. The new AI-based tool was introduced to **speed up** the process of chemical structure prediction. *accelerate*

B) Replacing Different Meanings of "Get" with Formal Equivalents

TASK: The verb "get" is highly versatile and used in various contexts with different meanings. Your task is to rewrite the following sentences by replacing "get" with more formal, precise verbs, depending on its meaning in each sentence.

Instructions:

1. Carefully identify the meaning of "get" in each sentence.
2. Replace "get" with an appropriate formal verb.
3. Maintain the original meaning of the sentence while making it suitable for academic writing.

Example Formal Verbs List:

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| • acquire | • obtain | • develop |
| • receive | • reach | • gain |
| • become | • achieve | • secure |

Sentences:

1. The students **got** the materials for the experiment from the lab technician.
2. In order to **get** accurate results, the researchers repeated the experiment multiple times. *achieve*
3. As the temperature increased, the liquid **got** more viscous, slowing the reaction.
4. It is crucial to **get** approval from the ethics committee before proceeding with the study. *obtain, gain*
5. The participants **got** tired after a long series of cognitive tasks. *become*
6. The team aims to **get** funding for their project from a government grant. *secure*
7. The researchers **got** significant insights into the molecular structure through advanced imaging techniques. *gained*
8. After the conference, the professor **got** a number of requests to collaborate on similar projects. *received*
9. As a result of prolonged exposure to hazardous chemicals, some workers **got** respiratory problems. *dev*
10. It took the team several weeks to **get** to the desired level of precision in their algorithm. *reach*

C) TASK: Rewrite the above text in formal academic language, replacing the phrasal verbs with formal equivalents and improving the overall tone.

Scientists have been **looking into** the effects of climate change on coral reefs for years. These ecosystems have been **breaking down** due to rising ocean temperatures, which cause coral bleaching. In order to **figure out** how to help these ecosystems, researchers are **coming up with** various strategies. One approach is to **set up** artificial reefs to give marine life a new habitat. They also hope to **come up with** ways to **bring down** ocean temperature increases by reducing carbon emissions.

Another major issue is how pollutants **get into** the oceans. When toxic substances **build up** in marine ecosystems, they can harm both animals and plants. Scientists are working to **find out** how these chemicals **break down** over time, and how long they stay in the water. They're also trying to **get rid of** harmful plastics by developing biodegradable alternatives.

The research team is planning to **go over** all the data they've collected from their field studies. Once they've **gone through** everything, they'll need to **write up** their findings and **put forward** some recommendations for conservation efforts. Finally, they hope governments will **take up** these suggestions and **put into place** stronger regulations to protect marine environments.

D) Rewrite this text below in a more formal academic style, taking into account the features of academic style we have discussed in class.

Why Climate Change is Messing Up Our Planet

Climate change is really getting out of hand. Everyone's talking about it, but not much is being done to sort it out. We're seeing the planet heat up faster than ever before, and it's causing all kinds of problems. The polar ice caps are melting like crazy, and sea levels are going through the roof. This is making it harder for animals like polar bears to get by. They're losing their homes and can't find enough food to stay alive.

On top of that, we're getting hit by extreme weather left, right, and center. Hurricanes, floods, and wildfires are popping up all over the place, and it's freaking people out. It's no secret that human activity is mostly to blame for all this. We're pumping out carbon dioxide and other nasty gases into the atmosphere, and it's trapping heat like nobody's business.

The thing is, if we don't get our act together soon, it could all go downhill real fast. Some scientists reckon we've only got a few years before things start spiraling out of control. It's high time we wake up and do something before it's too late.
